

Hunter College
Department of Computer Science

CSCI 39548: Practical Web Development
Summer 2026

Assignment 1 — Personal Portfolio Page + Git/GitHub Workflow

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Weight	10% of course grade
Released	Monday, June 1, 2026
Due	Monday, June 8, 2026, by 6:40 PM (before class)
Submission	Brightspace — paste a link to your public GitHub repository + a link to your merged pull request
Type	Individual

1 Overview

Build a small **personal portfolio website** in hand-written HTML and CSS, and — just as importantly — produce it using a proper **Git/GitHub workflow**: a repository, a feature branch, a pull request, and a merge.

This assignment has two equally important halves:

1. **The page** — semantic, responsive HTML/CSS you wrote by hand.
2. **The workflow** — how you used Git and GitHub to get there.

Both are graded. A beautiful page committed straight to **main** with one commit called “stuff” will lose significant points.

*Note: No frameworks. Write plain HTML and CSS. Do **not** use Tailwind, Bootstrap, React, or any build tool — we haven’t covered them yet, and the point here is the fundamentals.*

2 Learning Objectives

- **CO1** — Apply a collaborative Git/GitHub workflow: branches, commits, pull requests, and review.
- **CO2** — Build a responsive, accessible web page using semantic HTML and CSS.

3 Part 1 — The Portfolio Page

Build a single-page (or small multi-page) personal site. It must include **all** of the following:

- **Semantic structure** — use `<header>`, `<nav>`, `<main>`, `<section>`, and `<footer>` appropriately (not `<div>` for everything).
- **A navigation bar** with links to the page's sections (or pages).
- **At least three content sections** — e.g., About / Projects / Contact.
- **An image** (a photo, avatar, or project screenshot).
- **A list** (`<ul>` or `<ol>`) used somewhere meaningful.
- **A contact form** (`<form>` with labeled inputs and a submit button). It does **not** need to actually send anything.
- **An external stylesheet** (`styles.css`) — no inline `style="..."` and no large `<style>` block in the HTML.
- **A responsive layout** built with **flexbox or CSS grid**, including at least **one @media query** so the page looks good on both phone and desktop widths.

Content can be about you, a fictional persona, or a hobby — your choice. Keep it tasteful and appropriate.

4 Part 2 — The Git/GitHub Workflow

This is the half people underestimate. You must:

- Create a **public repository on GitHub** for this project.

- Include a `README.md` describing the project in a few sentences.
- Include a `.gitignore` (even a minimal one, e.g. ignoring `.DS_Store`).
- Do your work on **at least one feature branch** (e.g. `feature/contact-form`) — **not** directly on `main`.
- Make **several meaningful commits** with clear messages (e.g. “Add responsive nav bar”, not “update”).
- Open **at least one pull request** from your feature branch into `main`, then **merge it**.

You’re working solo, so you’ll be opening and merging your own PR — that’s fine. The goal is to practice the exact workflow you’ll use on the team final project.

5 Submission

Submit on **Brightspace**. In the submission text box, paste **two links**:

1. **Your public GitHub repository URL** — e.g.
`https://github.com/yourusername/portfolio`
2. **Your merged pull request URL** — e.g.
`https://github.com/yourusername/portfolio/pull/1`

Make sure the repository is **public** (or the grader cannot open it). Do **not** submit a `.zip` file and do **not** submit a deployed link — a link to the repo is all we need. The portfolio is reviewed by opening your HTML locally from the repo.

Note: Double-check your links work in a private/incognito window before submitting.

6 Grading Rubric (100 pts)

Criterion	Pts
Semantic HTML — correct, meaningful use of structural elements	20
CSS & layout — clean styling, flexbox/grid layout	20
Responsive design — works on mobile + desktop; @media query present	15
Git workflow — feature branch + pull request + merge (not committed straight to main)	25
Commit quality & repo hygiene — clear messages, README.md, .gitignore	10
Code readability — indentation, sensible names, no dead/commented-out clutter	10

7 Notes

- **Late policy:** see the syllabus. Submissions may be accepted up to one week late (with prior contact) at up to -20% per day.
- **Use of AI:** you may use AI tools (ChatGPT, Claude, Copilot, etc.) to help you learn and build, but you must be able to **explain every line you submit** in your own words if asked. Don't submit HTML/CSS you can't read.
- **Getting help:** bring questions to class or email to set up office hours.

End of Assignment 1